



Fresh take: Pooja Vastrakar (centre) and Arundhati Reddy have added more pace and variations to their game. R. RAGU

A SONG OF RESILIENCE, RESURGENCE AND REDEMPTION

The upcoming Women's T20 World Cup has seen contrasting build-ups for the participating teams, with India gearing up to bid for its **maiden ICC trophy.**

Lavanya Lakshmi Narayanan
lavanya.ln@thehindu.co.in

The final few grains of sand are falling in the hourglass ahead of the Women's T20 World Cup, which will be played in the heat and humidity of the United Arab Emirates (UAE). However, India's run-up to the biennial event has been unusually cold.

Harmanpreet Kaur will lead India's campaign, starting under the lights on October 4 against New Zealand in Dubai.

Grouped alongside the White Ferns, defending champion Australia, reigning Asia Cup champion Sri Lanka, and Pakistan, India has seen a rather quiet build-up, with no international matches for nearly two months before the showpiece event.

The national team was last in action in the T20 Asia Cup final against Chamari Athapaththu's Sri Lanka in late July. After largely cruising through the group stage, poor fielding and struggles against spin came back to haunt India once more. **The Women in Blue eventually relinquished their Asian crown to their neighbour.**

India arrived at its 15-member squad after months of significant tinkering — this involved workload management, motivated rotations, and trial and error with players of promise based on current form.

One such experiment was the extended opportunity given to Dayalan Hemalatha at number 3 in the batting line-up. Despite plenty of